



RESEARCH / PROJECT ETHICS REVIEW FORM
For Thesis / Capstone / Dissertation Proposals
(ver.Oct2024c)

Names of Student Researcher(s):

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Research/Thesis/Capstone Title: To Predict Is To Believe: Integrating Content, Context, and Creator Features For Pre-Publication Short-Form Video Engagement Prediction

College: College of Computer Studies

Department: Department of Software Technology

Course: Bachelor of Science in Computer Science Major in Software Technology

Expected Duration of the Project: from: Mar 25, 2026 to Apr 16, 2027

PROTOCOL:

(To be filled up by proponents; Use the Ethics Checklists as guides in determining areas for ethical concern/consideration. Attach and properly reference the accomplished ethics checklists and supporting documents.)

		Reference Document (include page number)
Target participants	Active Filipino TikTok content creators who maintain a professional account. Participants must be at least 18 years old and have between 10,000 and 100,000 followers. They must be willing to share their videos and analytics from the past year for this research.	Section 4.1.1.1: Participants, pg 42
Data to be used / collected	Data to be Used / Collected - Multimodal Content: Raw MP4 video files, captions, and hashtags. - Creator Metadata: Follower count and account age (measured as the number of days since the creator's first post). - Contextual Data: Posting day and posting time.	Section 4.1.2: Dataset Preparation, pg 51-53
Brief procedure	1. Recruitment: Candidate creators are contacted by email with the study details, the informed consent form, the TikTok Analytics Exporter extension, the TokDrop link, and a unique access code.	Section 4.1.1.3: Protocol, pg 49

	2. Analytics Export: The creator installs the TikTok Analytics Exporter Chrome extension and exports two CSV files (per-video analytics and follower count history) to their own device. 3. Submission: The creator logs in to TokDrop with their access code, reviews and agrees to the informed consent form, and uploads the two CSV files. 4. Video Download: The research team downloads each video from TikTok's built-in download option using the video IDs in the submitted CSVs. Only publicly available, creator-authorized videos are retrieved; no scraping or access to non-public data occurs. 5. Anonymization: Researchers strip identifying fields (account handle, profile name, contact email) and replace the creator handle with a randomized alphanumeric ID. 6. Verification: Each analytics row is matched to its downloaded video by video ID; rows with no matching video are excluded from the dataset.	
Potential risks	- Privacy Breach: Risk of re-identification if metadata is linked to a public profile. - Data Misuse: Risk of downloaded video files being used for purposes outside this specific research.	Section 4.1.1.3: Protocol, pg 49
Applicable Terms of Use or Licensing Agreement of Data, Models and/or Tools	- TikTok Terms of Service: Data collection is compliant because it is user-initiated (data donation via the creator's own analytics export) rather than automated scraping. Video retrieval uses only publicly available content that the creator has explicitly made downloadable.	Section 4.1.1.2: Material and Section 4.1.1.3: Protocol , pg 44 & 49
Steps to safeguard the participants and/or data	- De-identification: Account handles, profile names, and contact emails are stripped, and handles are replaced with randomized alphanumeric IDs immediately after collection. - Data Retention: Non-anonymized data is kept for at most two years and anonymized data for at most three years, after which the files and the handle-to-ID mapping are deleted.	Section 4.1.1.3: Protocol pg 49

	- Right to Withdraw: Participants can request deletion of their donated data at any time before the final model aggregation.	
Other concerns and considerations	N/A	

PANEL'S ASSESSMENT/COMMENTS:

The group's study design does not pose harm to their participants. The design has address all relevant ethical concerns.

PANEL'S DECISION:

- ☒ **Approved** (*Proponent/s may proceed with the study/data collection*)
- ☐ **Modifications Required** (*Proponent/s should address ethical issues, follow the panel's recommendations for required modifications, and resubmit Ethics Review Form for approval before proceeding with the study or before starting with data collection*)
- ☐ **For Full Review** (*Proponent/s should submit the proposal to the University Research Ethics Review Committee (RERC) and obtain a research ethics clearance before proceeding with the study or before starting with data collection*)

JUSTIFICATION:

The study design has addressed all ethical considerations.



Samson, Briane Paul V.

Date: 2026-08-11



Tiam-Lee, Thomas James

Date: 2026-08-11



Laguna, Ann Franchesca

Date: 2026-08-11



Samson, Briane Paul V.

Date: 2026-08-11